Manuscript (Results section): Assignment Brief (Individual Product 2)

Foundations of Clinical Research · Level 1: From Clinical Question to Publication

Organisation: Neudata (*#ClearDataClearImpact*)

Who: every participant, on their own. There are no groups.

Required: a complete, submission-ready **Results section** for one FLUID-ICU question (Q1 to Q5), with a working title, Table 1 and one main results table or figure.

Optional: Methods, Introduction, Discussion and Abstract. Trainers give feedback on these too.

What we give you: the results. You do not analyse any data.

Shared: at the end of Session 6, when you choose your question.

Marked with: `Manuscript_Rubric.pdf`. Peer review: `Peer_Review_Instructions.pdf`.

1. Purpose

You write the Results section of a FLUID-ICU paper to the standard a journal expects: every number correct, every estimate with its 95% CI, tables that stand alone and no interpretation.

2. Choose one question (end of Session 6)

All five questions are worked through in Sessions 5 and 6 (Q1 in full). By the end of Session 6, choose one and tell the instructor in the chat or by email. Any number of participants may choose the same question. Q1 is modelled live in Session 7, so it is the easiest start.

Q	Research question	Main analysis in the results pack
Q1	Is a positive fluid balance by day 3 associated with higher 28-day mortality?	Crude and adjusted logistic regression (OR), Kaplan-Meier curves and Cox model (HR)
Q2	Is cumulative fluid balance associated with acute kidney injury (AKI)?	Crude and adjusted logistic regression
Q3	Is cumulative fluid balance associated with fewer ventilator-free days?	Linear regression and a non-parametric comparison
Q4	Is initial lactate associated with 28-day mortality, and does the answer change with how missing lactate is handled?	Logistic regression, complete-case analysis vs multiple imputation
Q5	Among survivors, is fluid balance associated with a longer ICU stay?	Median (IQR), linear regression on the log scale or non-parametric tests

3. What you receive (by email)

File	What it is for
`Results_Pack_QN.pdf` (N = your question)	All the numbers: participant flow, Table 1, results tables, figures, plain-language notes
`Manuscript_Template_IMRaD.docx`	Write in this template. The Results section is marked as required
`SAP_FLUID-ICU.pdf` and `Data_Dictionary.pdf`	Definitions and analysis methods, for the optional Methods
`Response_to_Reviewers_Template.docx`	For your reply to your reviewer

If something is missing from your results pack, ask the instructor.

4. What you write

Required

Part	What we expect
Working title	One line naming the population, exposure, outcome and design, e.g. "Positive fluid balance by day 3 and 28-day mortality in sepsis: a multicentre cohort study"
Results text	STROBE items 13 to 17, in this order: (1) participants and flow, (2) baseline characteristics (Table 1) and missing data, (3) outcome numbers per group, (4) the main result, crude and adjusted, with 95% CI, (5) other analyses in your pack (sensitivity, imputation or subgroup). About 400 to 600 words
Table 1	Baseline characteristics, from your results pack
Main results table or figure	e.g. crude and adjusted estimates, or the Kaplan-Meier curve (Q1)
AI-use statement	See section 6

Table 1 and the main results table or figure come ready in your results pack (one pack per question, Q1 to Q5). You copy and format them, and write the text.

Submission-ready means:

- every number agrees with your results pack
- percentages have denominators and estimates have 95% CIs
- each table and figure stands alone (title, units, n, abbreviations explained)
- no interpretation ("because", "suggests", "significant trend")
- written in the template, in the past tense

Optional (encouraged)

Part	Notes
Methods	STROBE items 4 to 12. All the information is in the results pack, the SAP and the data dictionary. Taught in Session 7
Introduction	Three paragraphs: what is known, what is not known, the aim. Taught in Session 8
Discussion	Six moves: answer, compare, explain, limitations, implications, conclusion. Taught in Session 8
Abstract	Structured, 250 words or fewer. Taught in Session 8

Send optional parts in the same file as your Results. They are not marked.

5. Timeline

When	What happens
Sessions 5 and 6	The class reads the data, Table 1 and the results together
End of Session 6 (5 December)	You choose your question and receive this brief
Session 7 (12 December)	IMRaD, Methods and Results taught. Manuscript workshop 1: the instructor writes the Q1 Results live with the class, then you start yours. **Your reviewer is announced**
Session 8 (19 December)	Introduction, Discussion, abstract and title taught. Manuscript workshop 2: improve your Results section
23:59, Sunday 20 December 2026 (Vietnam time)	Results draft due. Email it to your reviewer and to the instructor
Wednesday 30 December 2026	Review report due. Email it to the author and to the instructor
Saturday 9 January 2027	Revised Results section and response to the reviewer due

6. Rules

- **Numbers:** only from your results pack. Round without changing the meaning.
- **Language:** FLUID-ICU is observational. Write "associated with", never "caused" or "led to".
- **Missing data:** say how much was missing, as in your pack.
- **Originality:** your own words. Two participants with the same question have the same numbers but not the same text.
- **AI-use statement (required):** at the end, write either "AI use: none." or "AI use: [tool] was used to [improve the English / translate]. The author checked every sentence and takes full responsibility." AI must not produce results or write the text for you. Never paste a classmate's draft into an AI tool.

7. Submission and file names

Write in English. If English is impossible for you, Vietnamese is accepted. Send every file by email to the instructor, Vương Mỹ Lượng, at **myluong1710@gmail.com**.

File	Send to	Due
`Surname_Firstname_Results_QN.docx`, e.g. `Nguyen_An_Results_Q2.docx`	Your reviewer and the instructor	23:59, Sunday 20 December 2026
`Surname_Firstname_Review.docx` (your review of a classmate's draft)	The author and the instructor	Wednesday 30 December 2026
`Surname_Firstname_Results_QN_revised.docx` (tracked changes) and `Surname_Firstname_Response.docx`	The instructor	Saturday 9 January 2027

8.

- You receive a review from your classmate, and written comments from the instructors on the revised Results section (or on the draft, if no revision arrives) and on any optional parts.